

But then the duke impulsively changed sides and joined with Venice and Naples against the French. Naturally, Charles didn't like that, and neither did his successor, Louis XII. When all the fighting was over, Milan was under the control of the French.



King Charles VIII

Leonardo had no particular reason to dislike the French (he really didn't concern himself much with politics), and in fact the French were interested in Leonardo's work. However, Leonardo decided it was time to leave Milan.

He made brief stays in Mantua and Venice before finally returning to Florence. He had been gone for 18 years, and the city had changed in his absence. The Medicis were no longer in power (though they were secretly plotting their return). As for the people of Florence, they

